Learn with Anil
learnwithanil.in

APPSC GROUP-1 MAINS
2026–27

# Paper I

## General Essay

Previous essay topics, sorted by syllabus · with practice topics



**27** Previous essay topics
2020, 2023 and 2025 papers

**7** Syllabus parts
how many came from each

**42** Practice essay topics
on every part, including recent news


BY

**Anil Kumar Jupudi**

Founder, Learn with Anil · learnwithanil.in



Edition: October 2026

Syllabus as per APPSC Notification 07/2026

# Paper I at a glance

How many previous essay topics came from each part of the syllabus.

**9** essay topics in the 2020 paper + **9** essay topics in the 2023 paper + **9** essay topics in the 2025 paper = **27** essay topics in this book

Each paper has 3 sections with 3 essay topics in each. You write 1 essay from each section (50 marks each), so every paper offers 9 topics.

| Part | Syllabus part | 2020 | 2023 | 2025 | Total | Page |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Current Affairs: Big News of the Year** | 3 | 2 | 1 | **6** | 2 |
| 2 | **Society, Politics and Governance** | 1 | 3 | 3 | **7** | 3 |
| 3 | **Economy, Jobs and Development** | 1 | 2 | 3 | **6** | 5 |
| 4 | **Environment, Water and Sustainability** | 1 | 1 | 2 | **4** | 7 |
| 5 | **Culture, Heritage and History** | 1 | 0 | 0 | **1** | 8 |
| 6 | **Civic Sense and Responsible Citizenship** | 1 | 0 | 0 | **1** | 9 |
| 7 | **Reflective and Philosophical Topics** | 1 | 1 | 0 | **2** | 10 |
| | **All parts** | **9** | **9** | **9** | **27** | |

ASKED THE MOST

**Society, Politics and Governance**

7 of 27 essay topics, about 1 in every 4.

RISING THE MOST

**Part 2: 1 → 3 → 3**

Society, Politics and Governance, in 2020, 2023, 2025.

ASKED THE LEAST

**Culture, Heritage and History**

Only 1 of 27 essay topics.

**Each part of this book has three things:** ① how many essay topics came from each topic ② the exact essay topics asked ③ practice essay topics to write.

Learn with Anil

PART 1 OF 7

# Current Affairs: Big News of the Year

1

Essays built on a specific recent event, crisis, law or launch that was in the news when the paper was set.

| 6 | 3 | 2 | 1 |
|---|---|---|---|
| essay topics in 3 papers | in 2020 | in 2023 | in 2025 |

## 1 How many essay topics came from each topic

| Topic | 2020 | 2023 | 2025 | Total |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| India's security and foreign relations | 1 | 1 | 0 | 2 |
| Pandemics and public-health alarms | 1 | 0 | 1 | 2 |
| Digital money and new technology | 0 | 1 | 0 | 1 |
| New laws and policy drafts in the news | 1 | 0 | 0 | 1 |
| Science, space and national achievements | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 |

## 2 The essay topics asked

### India's security and foreign relations

asked 2 times

**2023** Sec II (b) — "India possesses a countless number of soft power resources that could prove to be greatly beneficial if harnessed properly." In this connection, examine India's soft power - its challenges and opportunities.

**2020** Sec I (b) — Chinese Aggression and India: A Strategic Response

### Pandemics and public-health alarms

asked 2 times

**2025** Sec III (c) — Obesity is a silent pandemic undermining India's public health gains.

**2020** Sec I (c) — Measures to Combat Outbreak of Covid 19: The Role of the Government and the Individual

### Digital money and new technology

asked 1 time

**2023** Sec I (a) — Is India's 'Digital Rupee' another version of Cryptocurrency ? Examine India's progress on 'Central Bank Digital Currency' (CBDC) and its implications.

Learn with Anil

### New laws and policy drafts in the news

asked 1 time

**2020** Sec I (a) — The Draft Environment Impact Assessment (EIA) Notification of 2020: An Analysis

### Science, space and national achievements

not asked yet

## 3 Practice essay topics

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus themes, in APPSC style, to practise essay writing.

**P1** INDIA'S SECURITY AND FOREIGN RELATIONS · IN THE NEWS
Operation Sindoor and India's new approach to cross-border terrorism.

**P2** SCIENCE, SPACE AND NATIONAL ACHIEVEMENTS · IN THE NEWS
From Rakesh Sharma to Shubhanshu Shukla: India's journey towards human spaceflight.

**P3** DIGITAL MONEY AND NEW TECHNOLOGY
Artificial Intelligence in India: an engine of growth or a threat to jobs?

**P4** PANDEMICS AND PUBLIC-HEALTH ALARMS
Lifestyle diseases are India's next public-health emergency.

**P5** NEW LAWS AND POLICY DRAFTS IN THE NEWS
The new criminal laws: a real break from the colonial past?

**P6** INDIA'S SECURITY AND FOREIGN RELATIONS
India as the voice of the Global South: opportunities and responsibilities.

PART 2 OF 7

# Society, Politics and Governance

2

How Indians live together and are governed: unity, gender, representation and public services.

| 7 | 1 | 3 | 3 |
|---|---|---|---|
| essay topics in 3 papers | in 2020 | in 2023 | in 2025 |

## 1 How many essay topics came from each topic

| Topic | 2020 | 2023 | 2025 | Total |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Unity in diversity: religion, ethnicity and language** | 0 | 1 | 2 | **3** |
| **Women's rights and gender equality** | 1 | 1 | 0 | **2** |
| **Population, federalism and political representation** | 0 | 0 | 1 | **1** |
| **Governance reforms and public service delivery** | 0 | 1 | 0 | **1** |
| **Caste, social justice and weaker sections** | 0 | 0 | 0 | **0** |

## 2 The essay topics asked

### Unity in diversity: religion, ethnicity and language

asked 3 times

**2025** Sec I (a) — Ethnic conflicts in India: A growing threat to national integration and inclusive development.

**2025** Sec I (b) — The Three-Language Formula under NEP: Balancing Regional Identity and National Unity in India.

**2023** Sec II (c) — Ek Bharat Shrestha Bharat is the call to forge national integration and the spirit of collective consciousness. Examine whether India has succeeded to rise above the forces of communal prejudice.

### Women's rights and gender equality

asked 2 times

**2023** Sec III (a) — Examine the challenges and progress of gender equality and women's rights in the world since the 1995, 'Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action' (BPA).

**2020** Sec II (a) — Should there be Reservation for Women in Politics?

### Population, federalism and political representation

asked 1 time

**2025** Sec II (a) — Demographic Shifts in South India: Implications of Population Growth on Political Representation.

### Governance reforms and public service delivery

asked 1 time

**2023** Sec I (b) — Andhra Pradesh is the first state in India to have established village secretariats and thereby, signalling a march towards achieving Gandhian ideals. In this connection, discuss the pioneering work of 'the Grama Sachivalayam' in revolutionizing governance.

### Caste, social justice and weaker sections

not asked yet

Learn with Anil

## 3 Practice essay topics

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus themes, in APPSC style, to practise essay writing.

**P1** UNITY IN DIVERSITY: RELIGION, ETHNICITY AND LANGUAGE ● IN THE NEWS
Lessons from Manipur: rebuilding trust in a diverse society.

**P2** CASTE, SOCIAL JUSTICE AND WEAKER SECTIONS ● IN THE NEWS
Caste census: a tool for social justice or a risk of deeper divisions?

**P3** GOVERNANCE REFORMS AND PUBLIC SERVICE DELIVERY ● IN THE NEWS
WhatsApp governance in Andhra Pradesh: can technology bring the government to every citizen's doorstep?

**P4** WOMEN'S RIGHTS AND GENDER EQUALITY
Women-led development: from beneficiaries to leaders.

**P5** POPULATION, FEDERALISM AND POLITICAL REPRESENTATION
One Nation, One Election: strengthening democracy or weakening federalism?

**P6** GOVERNANCE REFORMS AND PUBLIC SERVICE DELIVERY
Corruption is a bigger enemy of development than poverty.

PART 3 OF 7

# Economy, Jobs and Development

3

Money, work and growth: who gains from growth, where jobs come from, and how cities and states develop.

| 6 | 1 | 2 | 3 |
|---|---|---|---|
| essay topics in 3 papers | in 2020 | in 2023 | in 2025 |

## 1 How many essay topics came from each topic

| Topic | 2020 | 2023 | 2025 | Total |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Economic growth, poverty and inequality** | 1 | 0 | 0 | **1** |
| **Population, jobs and workers' rights** | 0 | 0 | 2 | **2** |
| **Cities and urbanisation** | 0 | 1 | 0 | **1** |
| **Andhra Pradesh's growth sectors (tourism, industry, IT)** | 0 | 0 | 1 | **1** |
| **Agriculture, villages and co-operatives** | 0 | 1 | 0 | **1** |

## 2 The essay topics asked

### Economic growth, poverty and inequality

asked 1 time

**2020** Sec II (b) — Does the Rise or Fall of the Economic Growth Rate Really Make a Difference to the Poorest of the Poor?

### Population, jobs and workers' rights

asked 2 times

**2025** Sec I (c) — Demographic Dividend or Burden? Rethinking the Population Explosion Narrative.

**2025** Sec III (b) — Gig Economy in India: A Catalyst for Employment or a Challenge to Workers' Rights?

### Cities and urbanisation

asked 1 time

**2023** Sec III (b) — India is the second largest urban system in the world. In this connection, examine whether India is equipped with adequate urban planning and governance.

### Andhra Pradesh's growth sectors (tourism, industry, IT)

asked 1 time

**2025** Sec III (a) — Tourism in Andhra Pradesh : Assessing Challenges and Unveiling Opportunities for Growth.

### Agriculture, villages and co-operatives

asked 1 time

**2023** Sec I (c) — India has become the fifth largest economy in the world. Can India further aim to reach the top by actively engaging in the Co-operative Movement ? Examine.

## 3 Practice essay topics

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus themes, in APPSC style, to practise essay writing.

**P1** ECONOMIC GROWTH, POVERTY AND INEQUALITY ● IN THE NEWS
India's fall in extreme poverty: celebrating progress and facing what remains.

**P2** POPULATION, JOBS AND WORKERS' RIGHTS ● IN THE NEWS
The new Labour Codes: can they protect gig workers and still create more jobs?

**P3** ANDHRA PRADESH'S GROWTH SECTORS (TOURISM, INDUSTRY, IT) ● IN THE NEWS
Visakhapatnam as India's AI hub: what it will take for Andhra Pradesh to lead the digital economy.

**P4** AGRICULTURE, VILLAGES AND CO-OPERATIVES
Making farming profitable is the key to a developed India.

**P5** CITIES AND URBANISATION
Smart cities or liveable cities: what should India's urban future look like?

**P6** ECONOMIC GROWTH, POVERTY AND INEQUALITY
Viksit Bharat 2047: the dream, the plan and the road ahead.

Learn with Anil

PART 4 OF 7

# Environment, Water and Sustainability

4

Nature and natural resources: balancing development with water, energy and a safe climate.

| 4 | 1 | 1 | 2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| essay topics in 3 papers | in 2020 | in 2023 | in 2025 |

## 1 How many essay topics came from each topic

| Topic | 2020 | 2023 | 2025 | Total |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Development versus environment | 0 | 0 | 1 | 1 |
| Water stress and water conservation | 1 | 0 | 1 | 2 |
| Clean energy and green transport | 0 | 1 | 0 | 1 |
| Climate change, disasters and pollution | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 |

## 2 The essay topics asked

### Development versus environment

asked 1 time

**2025** Sec II (b) — Andhra Pradesh's development push must balance industrial growth with environmental sustainability.

### Water stress and water conservation

asked 2 times

**2025** Sec II (c) — Water Stress in India: The Silent Crisis Endangering Health, Agriculture, and Federal Stability.

**2020** Sec II (c) — How to Maintain a Proper Balance Between Developmental Activities and Water Conservation?

### Clean energy and green transport

asked 1 time

**2023** Sec II (a) — "The world is now in the middle of a new mobility revolution" - Examine India's efforts at accelerating the deployment of electric vehicles (EVs).

### Climate change, disasters and pollution

not asked yet

Learn with Anil

## 3 Practice essay topics

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus themes, in APPSC style, to practise essay writing.

**P1** CLIMATE CHANGE, DISASTERS AND POLLUTION ● IN THE NEWS
Cyclone Montha and the lessons for coastal Andhra Pradesh.

**P2** CLEAN ENERGY AND GREEN TRANSPORT ● IN THE NEWS
Half of India's power capacity is now clean: the next steps in the energy transition.

**P3** WATER STRESS AND WATER CONSERVATION ● IN THE NEWS
Tap water for every home, but will there be water in every tap?

**P4** CLIMATE CHANGE, DISASTERS AND POLLUTION
Heatwaves: India's new silent disaster.

**P5** DEVELOPMENT VERSUS ENVIRONMENT
Mining and forests: can development and conservation go together?

**P6** CLIMATE CHANGE, DISASTERS AND POLLUTION
Plastic pollution: a problem we created and a problem we must solve.

PART 5 OF 7

# Culture, Heritage and History

5

India's past and its living traditions, and how to protect and pass them on.

| 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 |
|---|---|---|---|
| essay topics in 3 papers | in 2020 | in 2023 | in 2025 |

## 1 How many essay topics came from each topic

| Topic | 2020 | 2023 | 2025 | Total |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Protecting cultural heritage** | 1 | 0 | 0 | **1** |
| **Freedom struggle, history and great Indians (incl. Andhra Pradesh)** | 0 | 0 | 0 | **0** |
| **Festivals, arts and living traditions** | 0 | 0 | 0 | **0** |

## 2 The essay topics asked

### Protecting cultural heritage

asked 1 time

**2020** Sec III (a) — The Role of the Youth in Preserving India's Cultural Heritage

| | |
|---|---|
| **Freedom struggle, history and great Indians (incl. Andhra Pradesh)** | not asked yet |
| **Festivals, arts and living traditions** | not asked yet |

## 3 Practice essay topics

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus themes, in APPSC style, to practise essay writing.

**P1** FESTIVALS, ARTS AND LIVING TRADITIONS · IN THE NEWS
Deepavali on UNESCO's heritage list: why living traditions need protection.

**P2** FREEDOM STRUGGLE, HISTORY AND GREAT INDIANS (INCL. ANDHRA PRADESH) · IN THE NEWS
150 years of Vande Mataram: the song that united a nation.

**P3** PROTECTING CULTURAL HERITAGE · IN THE NEWS
World Heritage status: an honour or a responsibility?

**P4** FREEDOM STRUGGLE, HISTORY AND GREAT INDIANS (INCL. ANDHRA PRADESH)
The contribution of Andhra Pradesh to India's freedom struggle.

**P5** FESTIVALS, ARTS AND LIVING TRADITIONS
From Kuchipudi to Kalamkari: keeping Andhra Pradesh's arts alive in a modern world.

**P6** PROTECTING CULTURAL HERITAGE
Monuments and museums as classrooms for the young.

PART 6 OF 7

# Civic Sense and Responsible Citizenship

6

Everyday behaviour of citizens: public manners, rights and duties, and safe conduct online.

| 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 |
|---|---|---|---|
| essay topics in 3 papers | in 2020 | in 2023 | in 2025 |

## 1 How many essay topics came from each topic

| Topic | 2020 | 2023 | 2025 | Total |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Civic sense in public places** | 1 | 0 | 0 | **1** |
| **Voting, rights and duties of citizens** | 0 | 0 | 0 | **0** |
| **Safe and responsible digital life** | 0 | 0 | 0 | **0** |

## 2 The essay topics asked

### Civic sense in public places — asked 1 time

**2020** Sec III (b) — Civic Sense and Public Spaces: An Urgent Need to Behave Responsibly

### Voting, rights and duties of citizens — not asked yet

### Safe and responsible digital life — not asked yet

## 3 Practice essay topics

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus themes, in APPSC style, to practise essay writing.

**P1** CIVIC SENSE IN PUBLIC PLACES ● IN THE NEWS
Clean cities are built by citizens: lessons from Swachh Survekshan.

**P2** VOTING, RIGHTS AND DUTIES OF CITIZENS ● IN THE NEWS
Clean voter lists, strong democracy: the debate over revising electoral rolls.

**P3** SAFE AND RESPONSIBLE DIGITAL LIFE ● IN THE NEWS
Online gaming and the young: why India banned real-money games.

**P4** SAFE AND RESPONSIBLE DIGITAL LIFE
Fake news spreads faster than truth: the citizen's duty in the digital age.

**P5** CIVIC SENSE IN PUBLIC PLACES
Road safety begins with each of us.

**P6** VOTING, RIGHTS AND DUTIES OF CITIZENS
Fundamental Duties: the forgotten half of the Constitution.

PART 7 OF 7

# Reflective and Philosophical Topics

7

Open-ended essays on a quotation, an idea or a personal experience, testing the candidate's own thinking.

| 2 | 1 | 1 | 0 |
|---|---|---|---|
| essay topics in 3 papers | in 2020 | in 2023 | in 2025 |

## 1 How many essay topics came from each topic

| Topic | 2020 | 2023 | 2025 | Total |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Famous quotations and big ideas | 0 | 1 | 0 | 1 |
| Personal experiences and life lessons | 1 | 0 | 0 | 1 |
| Values, happiness and the good life | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 |

## 2 The essay topics asked

### Famous quotations and big ideas

asked 1 time

**2023** Sec III (c) — 'Beauty is Truth, Truth is Beauty'

### Personal experiences and life lessons

asked 1 time

**2020** Sec III (c) — My First Public Speaking Experience

### Values, happiness and the good life

not asked yet

## 3 Practice essay topics

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus themes, in APPSC style, to practise essay writing.

**P1** VALUES, HAPPINESS AND THE GOOD LIFE ● IN THE NEWS
Happiness is not a number: what world happiness rankings miss about India.

**P2** VALUES, HAPPINESS AND THE GOOD LIFE ● IN THE NEWS
Yoga: India's gift for 'One Earth, One Health'.

**P3** FAMOUS QUOTATIONS AND BIG IDEAS
'Be the change you wish to see in the world.'

**P4** FAMOUS QUOTATIONS AND BIG IDEAS
'Education is the most powerful weapon to change the world.'

**P5** PERSONAL EXPERIENCES AND LIFE LESSONS
A failure that taught me more than success.

**P6** VALUES, HAPPINESS AND THE GOOD LIFE
Simple living, high thinking.

Learn with Anil